

Introduction to Network Security

Network Security

- Subject goals:
- To understand principles of network security:
 - cryptography and its *many* uses beyond “confidentiality”
 - authentication
 - message integrity
 - key distribution and certification
- Security in practice:
 - security in application, transport, network, link layers

- **Textbook:**

1. Network Security Essentials: Applications and Standards, 3rd Ed. William Stallings
2. Cryptography and Network Security: Principles and Practices, 4th Ed. William Stallings

Contents:

1. Cryptography

- Algorithms and protocols
 - Conventional and public key-based encryption, hash function, digital signatures, and key exchange and distribution

2. Network security applications

- Applications and tools
 - Kerberos, X.509v3 certificates, PGP, S/MIME, IP security, SSL/TLS, SET, and SNMPv3

Introduction

- A **network** consists of two or more devices that are linked in order to share resources or allow communications.
- **Security** is the act of **protecting** a **person**, **property** or **organization** from an attack.

Introduction

- **Computer Security**
 - Generic name for the collection of tools designed to protect data and to thwart hackers
- **Network Security**
 - Measures to protect data during their transmission

OSI Security Architecture

- ITU-T X.800 “Security Architecture for OSI”
 - A systematic way of defining and providing security requirements

ITU-T: International Telecommunication Union
Telecommunication Standardization Sector

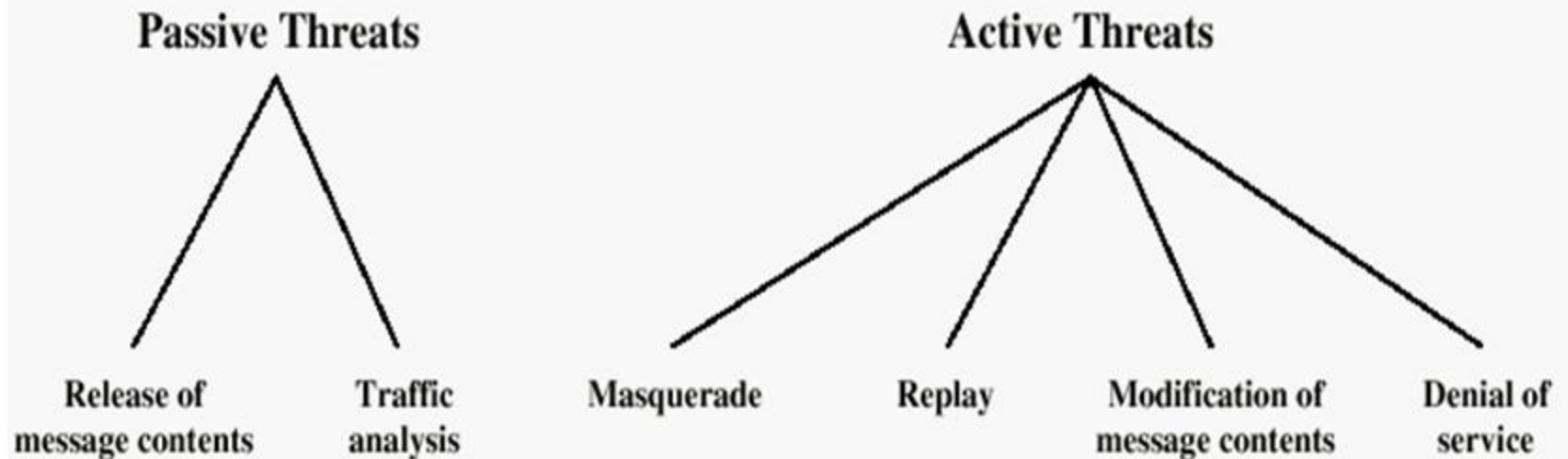
OSI: Open Systems Interconnection

Aspects of Information Security

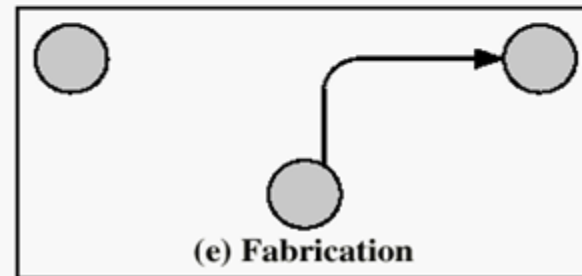
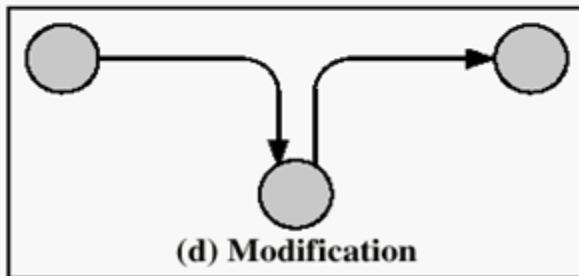
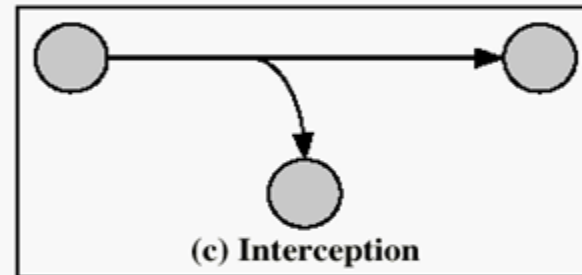
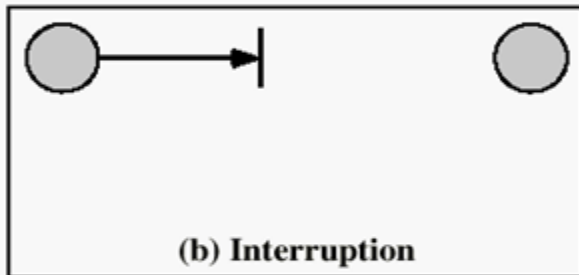
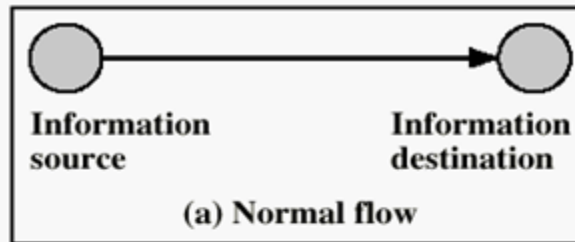
- **Security Attack**
 - Any action that compromises the security of information.
- **Security Mechanism**
 - A mechanism that is designed to detect, prevent, or recover from a security attack.
- **Security Service**
 - A service that enhances the security of data processing systems and information transfers.
 - Makes use of one or more security mechanisms.

Security Attacks

- There are a wide range of attacks
 - Two generic types of attacks
 - Passive
 - Active



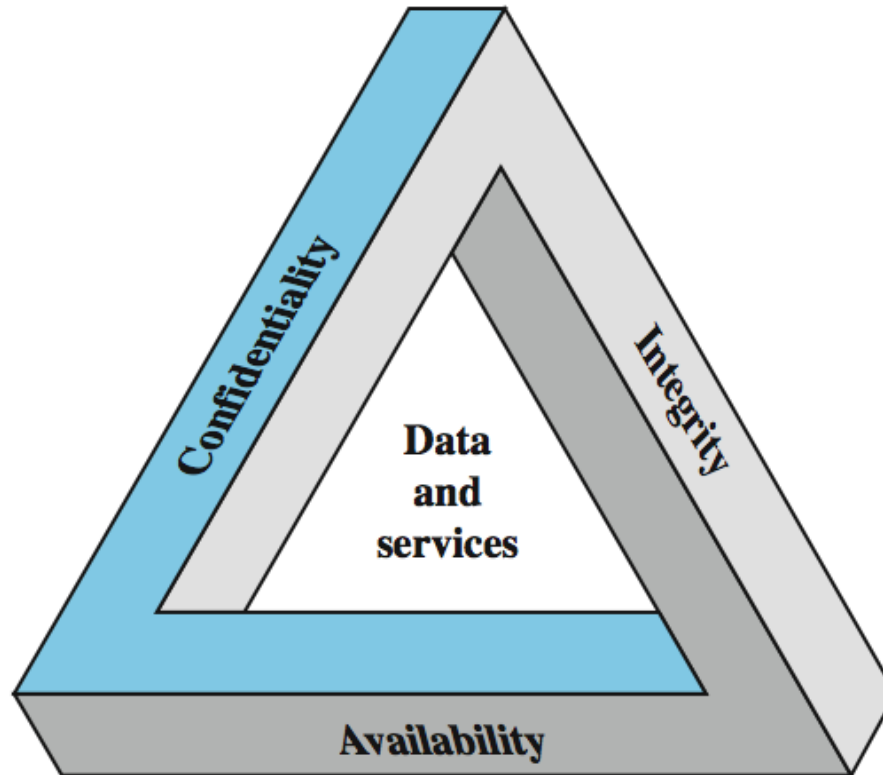
Security Attack Classification



Security Attacks

- **Interruption:** This is an attack on availability
- **Interception:** This is an attack on confidentiality
- **Modification:** This is an attack on integrity
- **Fabrication:** This is an attack on authenticity

Primary Security Goals



Security Services

X.800

- A service provided by a protocol layer of communicating open systems, which ensures adequate security of the systems or of data transfers
- Confidentiality (privacy)
- Authentication (who created or sent the data)
- Integrity (has not been altered)
- Non-repudiation (the order is final)
- Access control (prevent misuse of resources)
- Availability (permanence, non-erasure)
 - Denial of Service Attacks
 - Virus that deletes files

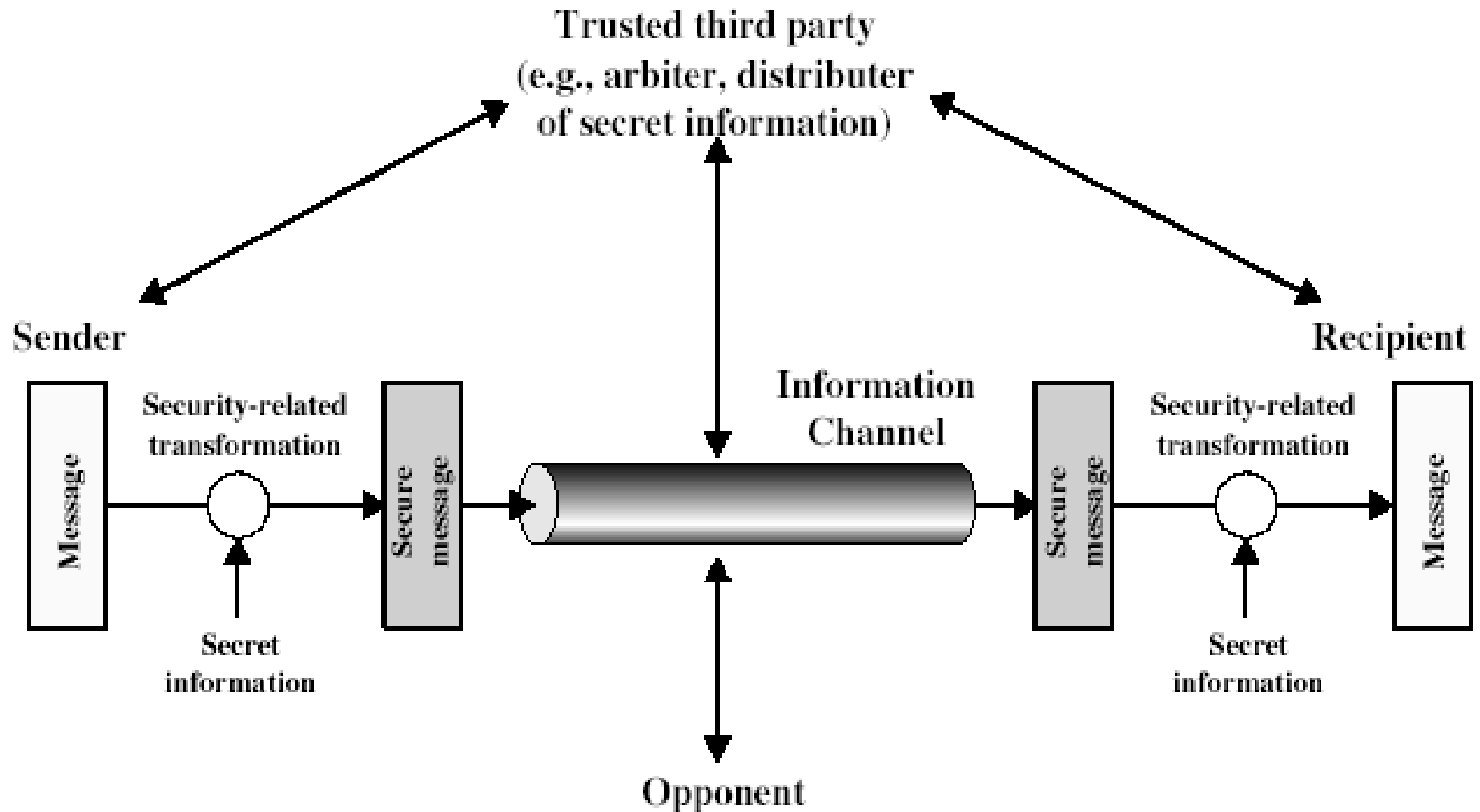
Security Mechanism

- These are the specific means of implementing one or more security services.
- Features designed to detect, prevent, or recover from a security attack
- No single mechanism that will support all services required
 - **Cryptographic techniques are the basis of almost all security mechanisms**

Security Mechanisms (X.800)

- Specific security mechanisms:
 - Encipherment, digital signatures, access controls, data integrity, authentication exchange, traffic padding, routing control, notarization
- Pervasive security mechanisms:
 - Trusted functionality, security labels, event detection, security audit trails, security recovery

Model for Network Security



Methods of Defense

- Encryption
- Software Controls
 - Limit access in a database or in operating systems
 - Protect each user from other users
- Hardware Controls
 - Smartcard (ICC, used for digital signature and secure identification)
- Policies
 - Frequent changes of passwords
 - Recent study shows controversial arguments
- Physical Controls

Internet standards and RFCs

- Three organizations in the Internet society
 - Internet Architecture Board (IAB)
 - Defining overall Internet architecture
 - Providing guidance to IETF
 - Internet Engineering Task Force (IETF)
 - Actual development of protocols and standards
 - Internet Engineering Steering Group (IESG)
 - Technical management of IETF activities and Internet standards process

Conclusion

- Computer networks are typically a shared resource used by many applications representing different interests.
- Unless security measures are taken, a network conversation or a distributed application may be compromised by an adversary.